Lecture # 4

Managing Stress and Emotions

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Managing Stress and Emotions

Facing Foreclosure: Case of ***Camden Property*** Trust

- For the third year in a row, **Camden Property Trust** has been named one of Fortune magazine's "100 Best Companies to Work For."
- In 2010, the company went from 41 on the list to ***number 10***.
- Established in 1982 and headquartered in Houston, Texas, Camden Property owns and develops ***residential apartment*** .
- With 183 properties and ***63,286 apartment*** , the real estate giant focuses its development on the fastest-growing markets in the US.
- But like so many organizations in the real estate industry during the ***2007-2008*** subprime ***mortgage crises***, business took a turn for the worst, and the company was faced with a substantial slowdown.

Managing Stress and Emotions

Facing Foreclosure: Case of *Camden Property* Trust

- Part of Camden's success during the transition was the company's ability to give staff the necessary information about the situation.
- Reinforcing the culture of fun at a past annual conference, the then CEO of Camden dressed as Captain Kirk from ***Star Trek*** and referred to the tough economic times as "attacks" on the company, and then he ***laid out a plan of action*** to bring about victory.
- Camden has found a way to successfully relate its organizational culture through various modes of communication.
- The ***value*** and ***respect*** that Camden Property shows to its employees has carried over to the way it treats its customers.

Managing Stress and Emotions

Facing Foreclosure: Case of *Camden Property* Trust

- The company has discovered that doing the right thing makes good business sense.



- With the increase in ***fore-closures*** and ***unemployment***, Camden is marketing to individuals in tough financial situations, a segment of the population once thought of as undesirable tenets.

- "We will forgive a foreclosure, as long as they did not totally blow up their credit," says ***Camden CEO***.

Managing Stress and Emotions

Facing Foreclosure: Case of *Camden Property* Trust

- The company has also created layoff-proof leases, which grant extensions to people and allow them ***extra time*** to come up with the rent.
- If a resident loses his or her job, the company will let them out of their lease ***without penalty*** or try to get them into a ***less expensive unit***.
- Camden's ability to ***build trust*** with both its ***employees*** and its ***customers*** during a period of extreme emotional stress ensures that the company will have a committed organization moving forward.

Managing Stress and Emotions

Facing Foreclosure: Case of *Camden Property* Trust

What is learning from this case study?

Sincerity and ***Honesty*** can develop trust

and ***Mutual trust*** can ***reduce stress***

What is Stress?





What is Stress(زہنی دباؤ)?



- The term stress is often used to describe the ***negative feelings*** a person experiences when placed in a potentially ***threatening situation***.

- A clear distinction must be made between ***positive*** (good) stress and ***negative*** (bad) stress.

Stress – Definition

- Seyle (1956): The ***non-specific*** response of the body to any demand made on it.

- If we are placed in a situation in which . .
  - we feel ***pressurized***
  - unable to meet the task
  - or ***worried about*** the consequences
- . . we may experience a ***stress*** reaction.

- Stress may differ from one person to person.

What is Stress?

- We may not be able to ***avoid stress*** completely, but we can change how we respond to stress, which is a major benefit.



- Our ***ability*** to recognize, manage, and maximize our ***response to stress*** can turn an emotional (or physical) problem into a resource.

Stress Process

- Our basic human functions,
  - breathing,
  - blinking,
  - heartbeat, and
  - other ***unconscious actions***,
  - are ***controlled*** by our ***lower brains***.
- Just outside this portion of the brain is the semiconscious ***limbic system***, which plays a large part in ***human emotions***.
- Within this system is an area known as the ***amygdala***. The amygdala is responsible for, among other things, stimulating fear responses.
- Human brains respond to ***outside threats*** to our safety with a message to our bodies to engage in a "**fight-or-flight**"

Stress Process

- Our bodies prepare for these scenarios with an . .
  - Increased heart rate
  - Shallow breathing
  - Wide-eyed focus

- Hans Selye (one of the founders of the American institute of stress) believed that unmanaged stress could create . .
  - Physical diseases such as
    - ***ulcers*** and ***high blood pressure***
  - Psychological illnesses
    - such as ***depression***

Workplace Stressors

- Having a few stressors in our lives may not be a problem, but because stress is cumulative, having many stressors day after day can ***cause a buildup*** that becomes a ***problem***.
- Topping the list of stressful issues are
  - Money
  - Work
  - Housing
- We can say that all ***three issues*** come back to the workplace.
- How much we ***earn*** determines the kind of ***housing*** we can afford, and when job security is questionable, home life is generally affected as well.

Now we will examine the major stressors in the workplace

Role Demands

- ***Role ambiguity*** refers to ***vagueness*** in relation to what my responsibilities are.

- If you have started a new job and ***are unclear*** about what you were expected to do, you have experienced role ambiguity.

- Having high role ambiguity is related to . . .
  - higher ***emotional exhaustion***
  - more thoughts of leaving an organization
  - lowered job attitudes and performance

Role Demands

- ***Role conflict*** refers to facing ***contradictory*** demands at work.

- **Example:** your manager may want you to increase customer satisfaction and cut costs, while you feel that satisfying customers inevitably increases costs.

- In this case, you are experiencing ***role conflict*** because satisfying one demand makes it unlikely to satisfy the other.

Role Demands

- ***Role overload*** is defined as ***not having sufficient time*** and resources to ***complete a job***.
- When an organization downsizes, the remaining employees will have to complete the tasks that were previously performed by the laid-off workers, which often leads to role overload.
- Like role ambiguity, both role conflict and role overload have been shown to ***hurt performance*** and ***lower job attitudes***.

Research shows that role ambiguity is the strongest predictor of poor performance

Information Overload

- Messages reach us in countless ways every day.
  - ***Some are social*** advertisements that we may hear or see in the course of our day.
  - ***Others are professional*** e-mails, memos, voice mails, and conversations from our colleagues.
  - ***Others are personal*** messages and conversations from our loved ones and friends.

Information Overload

- Add these together and it's easy to see how we may be receiving more information than we can take in.
- This state of ***imbalance*** is known as **information overload**.
- It occurs when the information processing demands on an individual's time to perform interactions and internal calculations ***exceed*** the ***capacity*** of ***time available*** for such processing."

Work–Family Conflict

- Work–family conflict occurs when the demands from work and family are ***negatively affecting*** one another.
- Specifically, work and family demands on a person may be incompatible with each other such that ***work interferes*** with family life and family demands interfere with work life.
- This stressor has steadily increased in prevalence, as work has become more demanding and technology has allowed employees to work from home and be connected to the job ***around the clock***.

Work–Family Conflict

- Fact that more households have dual-earning families in which ***both parents work*** means household and childcare duties are no longer the sole ***responsibility of mother***.
- This trend only compounds stress from the workplace by leading to the spillover of family responsibilities (such as a sick child or elderly parent) to work life.
- Research shows that individuals who have stress in one area of their life tend to ***have greater stress*** in other parts of their lives, which can create a situation of escalating stressors.

Downsizing

- A study commissioned by the U.S. Department of Labor to examine over 3,600 companies from ***1980 -1994*** found that manufacturing firms accounted for the greatest incidence of major downsizings.

- The average percentage of firms by industry that downsized more than 5% of their workforces across the ***15-year period*** of the study was
  - Manufacturing (25%)
  - Retail (17%)
  - and Service (15%)

Downsizing

- Study of US mean more of less similar situations in other countries as well.
- ***Loss of a job*** can be a particularly stressful event, as you can see by its high score on the life stressors scale.
- It can also lead to other stressful events,
  - such as financial problems
  - which can add to a person's stress score
- Research shows that downsizing and job insecurity (worrying about downsizing) is related to greater stress, and ***lower performance*** and creativity.

Avoiding and Managing Stress

Individual Approaches to Managing Stress

- Individual approaches to ***Managing Stress***
  - Corporate Athlete
  - Flow (break into smaller part)
  - Diet
  - Exercise
  - Sleep
  - Time Management

Individual Approaches to Managing Stress

Corporate Athlete

- There are several ways to manage stress.
- One way is to harness stress's ***ability to improve*** our ***performance***.

- Jack Groppel was working as a professor of kinesiology and bioengineering at the University of Illinois when he became interested in applying the principles of athletic performance to workplace performance.
  - Could eating better
  - exercising more
  - and developing a positive attitude
  - turn distress into eustress?
- Answer was **Yes**

Individual Approaches to Managing Stress

- If professionals trained their minds and bodies to ***perform at peak levels*** through
  - Better nutrition
  - Focused training
  - and positive action
- they could become "***corporate athletes***" working at optimal physical, emotional, and mental levels.
- ***Corporate athlete*** approach to stress is a proactive (action first) rather than a reactive (response-driven) approach.
- ***Overdose of stress*** can cause some individuals to
  - Stop exercising,
  - Eat less nutritional foods,
  - and develop a sense of hopelessness
- corporate athletes ward off the potentially overwhelming feelings of stress by ***developing strong bodies***.

Individual Approaches to Managing Stress

Flow

- Another way to transform stress is by breaking challenges into ***smaller parts***, and embracing the ones that give us joy.
- We enter a state, fully focused on the task at hand, losing track of everything except our genuine connection to the challenge before us.
- This concept of total engagement in one's work, or in other activities, is called **flow.**

Diet

- Greasy foods often make a person feel tired. Why?
- Because it takes the body longer to digest fats, which means the body is diverting blood from the brain and making you feel lethargic.
- Eating big, heavy meals in the middle of the day may actually slow us down, because the body will be ***pumping blood to the stomach***, away from the brain.

Individual Approaches to Managing Stress

Exercise

- Exercise is another strategy for managing stress.
- The best kind of break to take may be a physically active one.
- Research has shown that ***physically active*** breaks lead to enhanced mental concentration and decreased ***mental fatigue***.

Sleep

- It is a vicious cycle. Stress can make it hard to sleep.
- Not sleeping makes it harder to focus on work in general, as well as on specific tasks.
- Tired folks are more likely to ***lose their temper***, upping the stress level of others.

Individual Approaches to Managing Stress

Time Management

- Time management is defined as the development of tools or techniques that help to make us ***more productive*** when we work.
- Effective time management is a major factor in ***reducing stress***, because it decreases much of the pressure we feel.
- Time management techniques include
  - Prioritizing,
  - Manageable organization,
  - Keeping a schedule such as a paper or electronic tool
- Just like any new skill, developing time management takes ***conscious effort,*** but the gains might be worthwhile if your stress level is reduced.

Organizational approaches to Managing Stress

- ***Stress-related*** issues cost ***businesses billions of dollars*** per year in absenteeism, accidents, and lost productivity.
- As a result, managing employee stress is an important concern for organizations as well as individuals.

Examples:

- IBM Corporation encourages its worldwide employees to take an online stress assessment that helps them create action plans based on their results.
- Even organizations such as General Electric Company (GE) that are known for a “winner takes all” mentality are seeing the need to reduce stress.

Organizational approaches to Managing Stress

Make Expectations Clear

- One way to reduce stress is to ***state*** your ***expectations*** clearly. Workers who have clear descriptions of their jobs experience less stress than those whose jobs are ill defined.

- Can you imagine the benefits of working in a place where every ***assignment was clear*** and employees were happy and focused on their work?
  - It would be a great place to work as a manager, too.
  - Managers may be unaware that their directives are increasing their subordinates' stress by upping their ***confusion.***
  - In this case, a gentle conversation that steers a project in a clearer direction can be a simple but powerful way to reduce stress.
  - In the interest of reducing stress on all sides, it's important to frame situations as opportunities for solutions as opposed to sources of anger.

Organizational approaches to Managing Stress

Create Fair Work Environments

- Work environments that are unfair and unpredictable have been labeled "toxic workplaces." ***Toxic workplace*** is one in which a company ***does not value*** its ***employees*** or treat them fairly.

- Organizations that value employees are more profitable than those that do not. The impact of human resource management practices on turnover, productivity, and corporate financial performance.

- Research shows that working in an environment that is seen as fair helps to buffer the effects of stress.

Organizational approaches to Managing Stress

Employee Assistance Programs

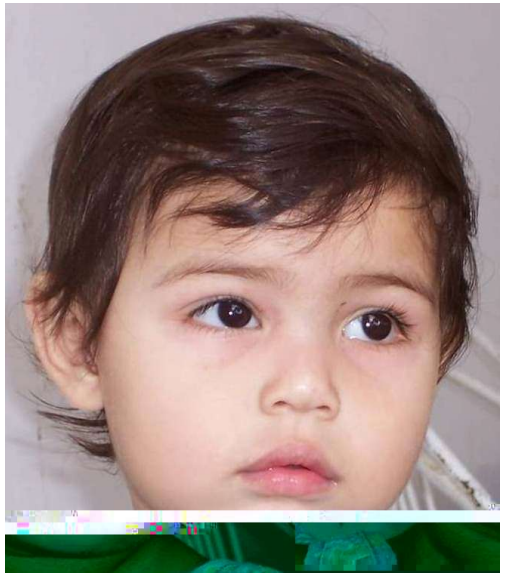
- There are times when life outside work causes stress in ways that will impact our lives at work and beyond.
- Situations may include the
  - death of a loved one
  - serious illness, drug dependencies
  - depression
  - legal or financial problems
- that are impacting on our work lives.
- Although treating such stressors is beyond the scope of an organization or a manager, many companies offer their employees outside sources of emotional counseling.
- ***Employee Assistance Programs*** (EAPs)are often offered to workers as an adjunct to a company provided health care plan.

What are Emotions?

What are Emotions?

Your reaction looking those











What are Emotions?

- Financial analysts measure the value of a company in terms of profits and stock. For employees, however, the ***value of a job is also emotional***.
- More formally, an emotion is defined as a short, intense feeling resulting from some event. Not everyone reacts to the same situation in the same way.
- **Example:** One manager's way of speaking
  - Can cause one person to feel ***motivated***
  - Second manager's style ***feel angry***
- Emotions can influence . . .
  - whether a person is receptive to advice
  - whether they quit a job
  - and how they perform individually or on a team

What are Emotions?

If my boss is like this ?





What are Emotions?

- Positive emotions such as joy, love, and surprise result from our reaction to desired events.
- In the workplace, these events may include ***achieving a goal*** or ***receiving praise*** from a superior.
- Individuals experiencing a ***positive emotion*** may feel peaceful, content, and calm.
- A positive feeling generates a sensation of having something you didn't have before, it may cause you to ***feel fulfilled*** and ***satisfied***.

What are Emotions?

- **Negative emotions** such as anger, fear, and sadness can result from ***undesired events***.

- These events may include . . .
  - Not having your opinions heard
  - Lack of control over your day-to-day environment
  - and ***unpleasant interactions*** with colleagues, or superiors

- Negative emotions play a role in the conflict process, with those who can ***manage negative emotions*** finding themselves in ***fewer conflicts*** than those who do not.

Emotions at Work

Emotions affect Attitudes & Behaviors at Work

- Emotions shape an individual's belief about the value of a job, a company, or a team. ***Emotions*** also affect behaviors at work.

- Research shows that individuals within your own inner circle are better able to recognize and understand your emotions.

What is the connection between emotions, attitudes, and behaviors at work?

Affective Events Theory

- **Affective Events Theory** (AET) is a psychological model designed to explain the connection between emotions and feelings in the workplace and job performance, job satisfaction and behaviors.

Emotions at Work

Affective Events Theory

- Connection may be explained using a theory named ***Affective Events Theory*** (AET).
- Researchers have studied the effect of ***six major*** kinds of **emotions** in the workplace:
  - Anger
  - Fear
  - Joy
  - Love
  - Sadness
  - Surprise
- **Affective events theory:** A theoretical discussion of the structure, causes and consequences of affective experiences at work.
- Their theory argues that specific events on the job cause different kinds of people to feel different emotions. These emotions, in turn, inspire actions that can benefit or impede others at work.

Affective Events Theory

- Imagine that a coworker ***unexpectedly*** delivers your morning coffee to your desk.
- As a result of this pleasant, if unexpected experience, you may ***feel happy*** and ***surprised***.
- If that coworker is your boss, you might ***feel proud*** as well.



Affective Events Theory



- Studies have found that the positive feelings resulting from work experience may inspire you to do something you hadn't planned to do before.
- For instance, you might volunteer to help a colleague on a project you weren't planning to work on before. Your action would be an ***affect-driven behavior*****.**
- Alternatively, if you were ***unfairly*** reprimanded by your manager, the negative emotions you experience may cause you to withdraw from work or to act mean toward a coworker.
- These tiny moments of emotion on the job can influence a person's job satisfaction.

Affective Events Theory



- ***Affective Events Theory*** model comes from the inside- in from the combination of . . .
  - an individual's personality,
  - small emotional experiences at work over time, beliefs,
  - and affect driven behaviors.

- Jobs that are high in negative emotion can lead to frustration and ***burnout***—an ongoing negative emotional state resulting from ***dissatisfaction***.

That is all